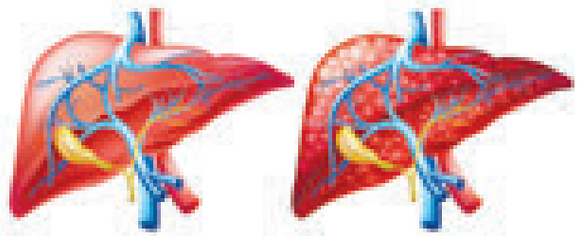
1.4.2 Cirrhosis

Cirrhosis is characterized by loss of functional cells and nodular regeneration of the liver cells.

CIRRHOSIS OF THE LIVER



NORMAL LIVER LIVER WITH CIRRHOSIS

Causes of Cirrhosis

- The causes include infectious hepatitis, chronic alcoholism in association with malnutrition.
- Non-alcoholic fatty liver disease has a number of causes, including being verweight, diabetes, high blood fats, and high blood pressure.

Symptoms of Cirrhosis

Gastrointestinal disturbances such as anorexia, vomiting, ascites, pain and swelling.

ASCITES

Ascites is the accumulation of abnormal amounts of fluid in the abdomen.

Principles of Diet therapy

A high calorie, high protein, high carbohydrate, moderate or restricted fat, high vitamin diet helps in the regeneration of liver and helps to prevent ascites. Vitamin supplementation is given. Sodium is restricted only when there is ascites.

Dietary Management

Energy: A 2000 -2500 kcals per day is needed. Most patients find it difficult to consume adequate calories because of anorexia and nausea. Several small meals are preferable to three large meals daily.

Carbohydrates: The carbohydrates content of the diet will be high 300 to 400g per day, in order to provide sufficient calories so that protein is not used for energy.

DO YOU KNOW?

Coconut oil is rich in Medium Chain Triglyceride.

Protein: A high protein diet is helpful for regeneration of the liver.

Fats: In cirrhosis, 20 g of fat is given. Medium chain triglycerides can be given.

Vitamins and Minerals: Vitamins and mineral supplementation is needed in all patients.

Sodium: Sodium restriction is prescribed if edema and ascites are present.

Fluids: Fluids may not be severely restricted if sodium restriction is effective in correcting edema and ascites.

Foods to be Avoided - Papad, pickles, preserved foods such as jams, jellies, sauces.

1.5 Overweight and Obesity

Obesity can be defined as the generalized accumulation of excess adipose tissue in the body resulting in an increase of more than 20 percent of the desirable weight or ideal weight. Overweight refers to person with body weight in excess of the weight-height standard but below the 20% excess designated as obesity.

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